

Data Protection and Confidentiality Policy

1. Purpose

Silverleaf Academy Ltd ("Silverleaf Academy" or "the Academy") is committed to protecting the privacy, confidentiality, integrity, and security of all information collected, stored, and processed by the Academy.

This Policy establishes principles and procedures for collecting, using, storing, sharing, and protecting information relating to employees, students, parents, applicants, suppliers, consultants, volunteers, and other stakeholders.

All employees are responsible for ensuring that personal and confidential information is handled appropriately and in accordance with this Policy.

2. Scope

This Policy applies to all:

- Employees;
- Directors;
- Consultants and contractors;
- Interns and volunteers;
- Temporary staff;
- Third-party service providers acting on behalf of the Academy.

This Policy applies to all information held in:

- Electronic systems;
- Paper records;
- Emails and electronic communications;
- Audio, video, and photographic records;
- Cloud-based storage systems;
- Mobile devices and removable storage devices.

3. Categories of Information

a) Organisational Information

Information relating to the Academy's operations, including:

- Policies and procedures;
- Budgets and financial information;
- Strategic plans;
- Marketing materials;
- Reports and statistics;
- Internal communications.

b) Personal Information

Information relating to identifiable individuals, including:

- Names;
- Addresses;
- Telephone numbers;
- Email addresses;
- Identification documents;
- Employment information;
- Student and parent information;
- Emergency contact details.

c) Sensitive Information

Information requiring enhanced protection, including:

- Employee payroll information;
- Medical information;
- Student welfare and safeguarding information;
- Child protection reports;
- Disciplinary records;
- Performance records;
- Background checks;
- Financial information;
- Information relating to investigations and grievances.

For purposes of this Policy, all persons and organizations whose information is held by the Academy shall be referred to as Data Subjects.

4. Data Protection Principles

Silverleaf Academy shall:

- Collect information lawfully and fairly;
- Collect only information that is necessary for legitimate educational and operational purposes;
- Inform individuals about the purpose for collecting their information;
- Use information only for the purposes for which it was collected;
- Keep information accurate and up to date;
- Protect information from unauthorized access, loss, misuse, alteration, or disclosure;
- Retain information only for as long as necessary;
- Dispose of information securely when no longer required.

5. Collection and Use of Information

The Academy may collect information for purposes including:

- Recruitment and employment administration;
- Payroll and statutory compliance;
- Student admissions and enrollment;
- Academic administration;
- Child safeguarding and welfare;
- Performance management;
- Leave and attendance administration;
- Emergency and health management;
- Communication with parents and stakeholders;
- Legal and regulatory compliance;
- Operational planning and reporting.

Where reasonably practicable, information shall be collected with the knowledge of the Data Subject.

6. Confidential Information

Confidential Information includes any information relating to the business and financial affairs of the Academy or information relating to its:

- Students;
- Parents and guardians;
- Employees;
- Applicants;
- Consultants;
- Suppliers;
- Service providers;
- Affiliates and partners.

Confidential Information includes but is not limited to:

- Student records and assessment information;
- Safeguarding and child protection information;
- Employee records and payroll information;
- Financial information and budgets;
- Fees and pricing information;
- Business plans and strategies;
- Marketing plans;
- Future projects and initiatives;
- Contracts and agreements;
- Internal reports and communications;
- Passwords and system credentials;
- Any information that could adversely affect the interests or reputation of the Academy if disclosed.

7. Non-Disclosure and Confidentiality Obligations

Employees are strictly prohibited from:

- Using confidential information for personal benefit;
- Disclosing confidential information to unauthorized persons;

- Sharing confidential information through personal email accounts or unauthorized platforms;
- Copying, downloading, photographing, or distributing confidential information without authorization;
- Discussing confidential information in public areas or with unauthorized persons.

These obligations apply during employment and continue after employment has ended.

Unauthorized disclosure of confidential information constitutes serious misconduct and may result in disciplinary action, termination of employment, and legal proceedings.

Any requests for confidential information from external parties shall immediately be referred to Management.

8. Access to Information

Access to information shall be limited to authorized persons who require the information for legitimate business purposes.

Employees shall access only information necessary to perform their duties.

Management may restrict access to information where necessary to protect confidentiality and safeguarding obligations.

9. Storage and Security of Information

Physical Records

The Academy shall ensure that:

- Employee files are stored securely;
- Student files are stored securely;
- Confidential documents are maintained in locked cabinets or secure offices;
- Documents are not left unattended in public areas.

Electronic Records

The Academy shall ensure that:

- Information systems are password protected;
- Access rights are controlled and monitored;

- Sensitive information is stored securely;
- Appropriate backup procedures are maintained;
- Electronic records are protected against unauthorized access.

10. Use of Academy Systems

The Academy currently uses:

Paytan

For:

- Employee records;
- Payroll administration;
- Statutory reporting;
- HR administration.

EdAdmin

For:

- Attendance management;
- Leave management;
- Employee information management;
- School administration functions.

Employees shall use these systems responsibly and protect passwords and login credentials.

Passwords shall not be shared with unauthorized persons.

11. Student Information and Child Safeguarding Data

Information relating to students and safeguarding matters is highly confidential.

Employees shall:

- Protect student privacy;
- Share student information only on a need-to-know basis;
- Maintain confidentiality of safeguarding concerns;
- Store safeguarding records securely;

- Avoid discussing student information with unauthorized persons.

Any breach involving student or safeguarding information may result in disciplinary action, including termination.

12. Sharing of Information

The Academy shall not disclose personal information except:

- Where consent has been obtained;
- Where disclosure is required by law;
- Where disclosure is necessary to protect a child;
- Where disclosure is necessary for educational administration;
- Where disclosure is necessary for legitimate operational purposes.

Information shared with third parties shall be limited to what is reasonably necessary.

13. Data Retention and Disposal

Information shall be retained only for as long as necessary for:

- Educational purposes;
- Employment administration;
- Legal requirements;
- Statutory obligations;
- Safeguarding obligations.

When information is no longer required, it shall be securely destroyed or permanently deleted.

14. Training and Awareness

All employees shall:

- Receive orientation on this Policy during onboarding;
- Participate in periodic training on confidentiality and data protection;
- Understand their responsibilities under this Policy;
- Sign an acknowledgment confirming compliance with this Policy.

15. Breach of this Policy

Any employee who:

- Accesses information without authorization;
- Discloses confidential information;
- Uses information improperly;
- Fails to protect information;
- Breaches safeguarding confidentiality requirements;

may be subject to:

- Verbal warning;
- Written warning;
- Suspension;
- Termination of employment;
- Legal action where applicable.

16. Policy Review

This Policy shall be reviewed periodically to ensure compliance with applicable laws, safeguarding standards, technological developments, and operational requirements of Silverleaf Academy.

Employee Acknowledgment

I acknowledge that I have read, understood, and agree to comply with the Silverleaf Academy Data Protection and Confidentiality Policy. I understand that my obligation to protect confidential information continues during and after my employment with Silverleaf Academy.

Employee Name: _____

Position: _____

Signature: _____

Date: _____